



PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT | WAITING TIME

Defining a waiting-time measure the service could trust

A health-service team needed one defensible measure of how long cases waited for assessment across a changing operational workflow.

QUESTION

How long did cases wait?

NEED

One operational definition

RESULT

Transparent performance view

THE ORGANISATION'S CHALLENGE

Several timestamps could plausibly mark the start or end of a wait. Cases could also move between levels, leave and return, or follow different routes into assessment.

Each interpretation produced a different answer. A useful measure had to reflect how the service understood the wait, deal openly with exceptions and remain stable when the workflow changed.

WHAT MAPLE LEAF DID

01

Mapped the operational journey and agreed the event that best represented the start and end of the wait.

02

Set clear rules for movement, re-entry, missing markers and changes in the way assessments were started.

03

Designed reporting that showed typical waits, long waits and the full shape of performance, with definitions and caveats kept visible.

WHAT CHANGED

One governed definition

- Leaders gained one transparent and repeatable waiting-time measure.
- Variation hidden by a single average became visible and investigable.
- The documented method became a reference for other complex measures.

